



Never give up: Young Player of the Tournament, Michelle Agyemang (No. 17), scored a stoppage-time equaliser for England against Italy in the semifinal.

REUTERS



The ugly side of the beautiful game

Despite many initiatives to tackle racism in the sport, it remains rampant. The latest victim was England's Jess Carter, who revealed that she had been receiving racial abuse online since the start of the campaign.

The England women's team, which traditionally takes the knee before kick-off as a gesture against racism, announced ahead of its semifinal fixture against Italy that it would not do so — in solidarity with Carter.

The players said in a joint statement: "We stand with Jess and all Lionesses past and present who have suffered racism. Representing your country is the greatest honour. It is not right that while we are doing that, some of us are treated differently simply because of the colour of our skin. It's clear that we and football need to find another way to tackle racism. We've agreed as a squad to remain standing before kick-off on Tuesday."

UEFA also expressed its support, stating: "Abuse and discrimination should never be tolerated, whether in football or society, in person or online. We stand with Jess."

Record-breaking numbers

The popularity of women's football continues to rise — and EURO 2025 was a powerful testament to this. UEFA confirmed that this edition was the best-attended Women's European Championship ever, with 29 of 31 matches sold out and several attendance records broken.

Ahead of the final, a record

623,088 spectators had attended the tournament, surpassing the previous total attendance record of 574,875 from the 2022 edition in England.

There were also several individual match records, according to UEFA.

The Germany vs Denmark match in Basel drew 34,165 fans — the highest attendance for a group game not involving the host nation, and the most spectators ever for a women's football match in Switzerland.

Meanwhile, the 34,063-strong crowd for Switzerland's match

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